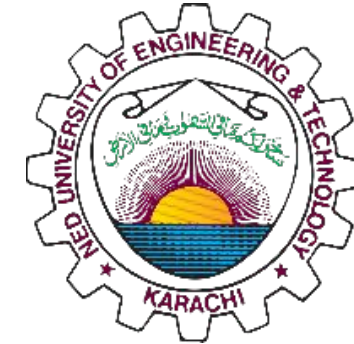


SE Computer Science – Fall 2022

Week	2
Lecture	4-6
Lecturer	Zermeena Khan

Thursday, October 20, 2022



Business Communication (HS-218)

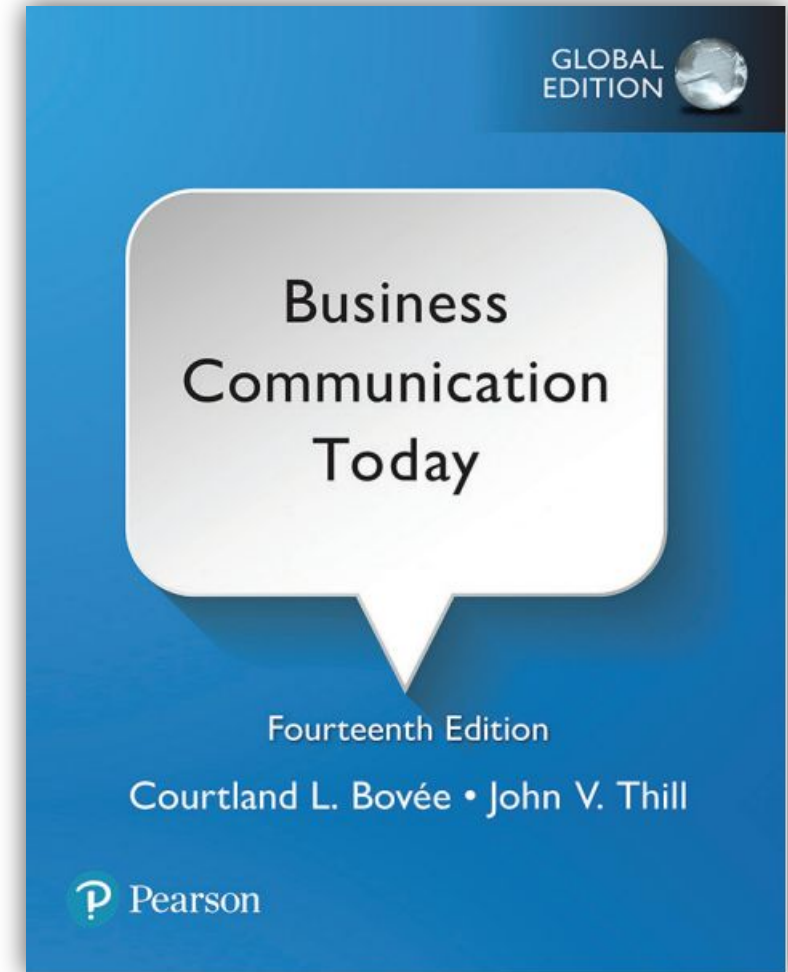
Today's topic: BC Foundations (Contd.)



What we will cover?

BC (HS-218)

- What are teams?
- Meetings
- Listening
- Non-Verbal Communication





How is a team developed?

BC (HS-218)

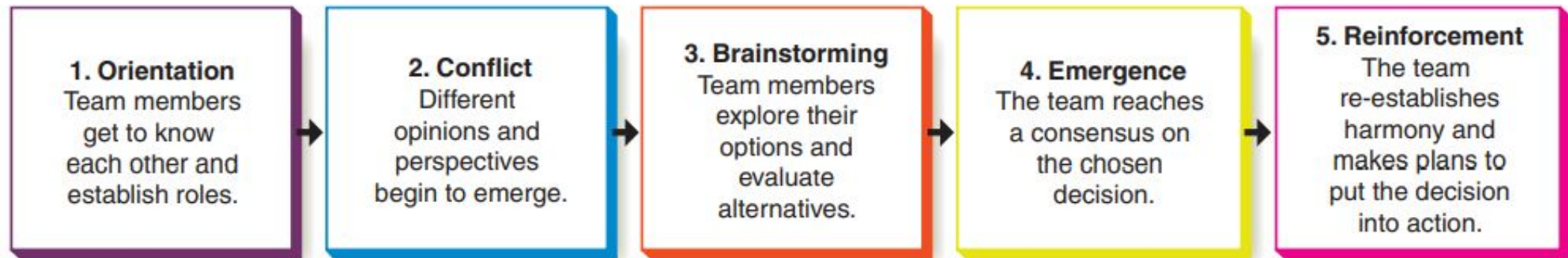


Figure 2.1 Phases of Group Development

Groups generally progress through several stages on their way to becoming productive and reaching their objectives.



Resolving CONFLICTS

BC (HS-218)

Proactive
Behavior

Communication

Openness

Research

Flexibility

Fair Play

Alliance



THE ART OF PROFESSIONALISM

Being a Team Player

Professionals know that they are contributors to a larger cause, that it's not all about them. Just as in athletics and other team efforts, being a team player in business is something of a balancing act. On the one hand, you need to pay enough attention to your own efforts and skills to make sure you're pulling your own weight. On the other hand, you need to pay attention to the overall team effort to make sure the team succeeds. Remember that if the team fails, you fail, too.

Great team players know how to make those around them more effective, whether it's by lending a hand during crunch time, sharing resources, removing obstacles, making introductions, or offering expertise. In fact, the ability to help others improve their performance is one of the key attributes executives look for when they want to promote people into management.

Being a team player also means showing loyalty to your organization and protecting your employer's reputation—one of the most important assets any company has. Pros don't trash their employers in front of customers or in their personal blogs. When they have a problem, they solve it; they don't share it.

CAREER APPLICATIONS

1. If you prefer to work by yourself, should you take a job in a company that uses a team-based organization structure? Why or why not?
2. You can see plenty of examples of unprofessional business behavior in the news media and in your own consumer and employee experiences. Why should you bother being professional yourself?



- Select collaborators
- Agree on project goals before starting
- Bonding time is a must
- Clarify individual responsibilities
- Establish a clear process
- Avoid composing as a group
- Compatible tools (Social Media, Web/ Mobile Apps like MS Teams, Intranet)
- Maintain harmony



TABLE 2.2 Giving Constructive Feedback

How to Be Constructive	Explanation
Think through your suggested changes carefully.	Many business documents must illustrate complex relationships between ideas and other information, so isolated and superficial edits can do more harm than good.
Discuss improvements rather than flaws.	Instead of saying “this is confusing,” for instance, explain how the writing can be improved to make it clearer.
Focus on controllable behavior.	The writer may not have control over every variable that affected the quality of the message, so focus on those aspects the writer can control.
Be specific.	Comments such as “I don’t get this” or “Make this clearer” don’t give the writer much direction.
Keep feedback impersonal.	Focus comments on the message, not on the person who created it.
Verify understanding.	If in doubt, ask for confirmation from the recipient to make sure that the person understood your feedback.
Time your feedback carefully.	Respond in a timely fashion so that the writer has sufficient time to implement the changes you suggest.
Highlight any limitations your feedback may have.	If you didn’t have time to give the document a thorough edit, or if you’re not an expert in some aspect of the content, let the writer know so that he or she can handle your comments appropriately.



PREPARE FOR IT

- Define your purpose
- Select participants
- Chose venue & time
- Set the agenda

MAKE IT MEANINGFUL

- Keep the discussion on track
- Follow agreed-on rules
- Encourage participation
- Participate actively
- Minimize distractions
- Close effectively

USE RESULTS EFFECTIVELY

- Distribute minutes
- Assign tasks clearly
- Minutes sample:



Microsoft Word
Document



← The agenda title clearly identifies the scope of the meeting.

← The clear and concise outline format identifies the topics that will be addressed and the order of discussion, which helps participants plan questions and suggestions.

← Establishing a time limit for each section helps keep the meeting on track and ensures that time will be available for every topic.



Content Listening

- Focusing on information purely
- No evaluation, neutral

Critical Listening

- Understanding the logic
- Strength of the evidence
- Implications of the message
- Speaker intentions/ motives

Empathic Listening

- Understand speaker's feelings, needs and wants
- Listening with empathy



The LISTENING process

BC (HS-218)

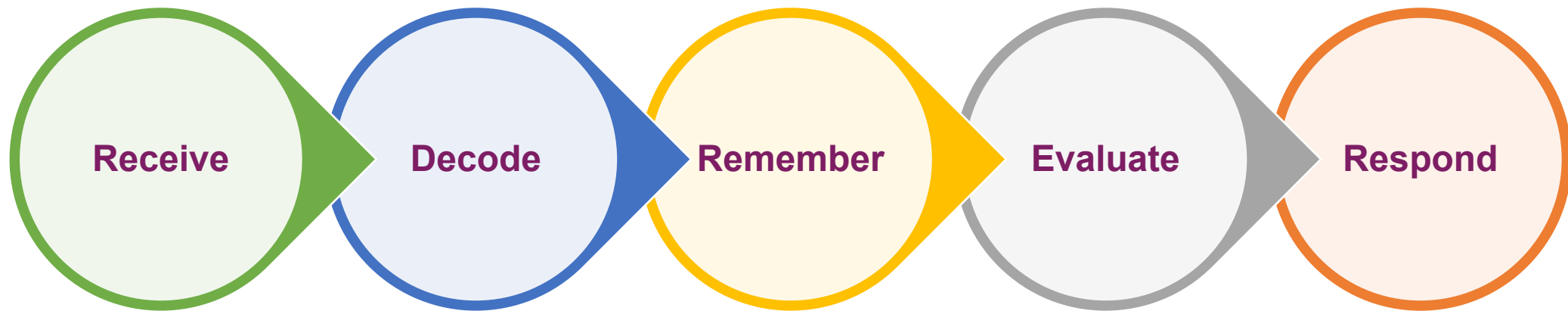




TABLE 2.3 What Makes an Effective Listener?

Effective Listeners	Ineffective Listeners
Listen actively	Listen passively
Take careful and complete notes, when applicable	Take no notes or ineffective notes
Make frequent eye contact with the speaker (depends on culture to some extent)	Make little or no eye contact—or inappropriate eye contact
Stay focused on the speaker and the content	Allow their minds to wander, are easily distracted, work on unrelated tasks
Mentally paraphrase key points to maintain attention level and ensure comprehension	Fail to paraphrase
Adjust listening style to the situation	Listen with the same style, regardless of the situation
Give the speaker nonverbal cues (such as nodding to show agreement or raising eyebrows to show surprise or skepticism)	Fail to give the speaker nonverbal feedback
Save questions or points of disagreement until an appropriate time	Interrupt whenever they disagree or don't understand
Overlook stylistic differences and focus on the speaker's message	Are distracted by or unduly influenced by stylistic differences; are judgmental
Make distinctions between main points and supporting details	Are unable to distinguish main points from details
Look for opportunities to learn	Assume they already know everything that's important to know



CHECKLIST ✓ Overcoming Barriers to Effective Listening

- Lower barriers to message reception whenever you can (such as avoiding interrupting speakers by asking questions or by exhibiting disruptive nonverbal behaviors).
- Avoid selective listening by focusing on the speaker and carefully analyzing what you hear.
- Keep an open mind by avoiding any prejudgment and by not listening defensively.
- Don't count on your memory; write down or record important information.
- Improve your short-term memory by repeating information or breaking it into shorter lists.
- Improve your long-term memory by using association, categorization, visualization, and mnemonics.



Recognizing NONVERBALS

BC (HS-218)

Facial
Expression

Gesture &
Posture

Vocal
Characteristics

Personal
Appearance

Touch

Time & Space



- ❖ You supervise a positive and enthusiastic new team leader who has sent an email to one of her team members and has copied you in it. The message is very short, with a demanding tone, and requires the completion of a rather complex piece of work within a very short deadline. You think the deadline will be very difficult to achieve and, knowing the recipient of message, you expect that the request might cause a very negative reaction, resulting in conflict within the team.
- ❖ Outline a course of action you could take to minimize a negative response and summarize appropriate developmental feedback for the new team leader.